Conversation track 8, 10, 11

Jade got to work two hours late today. At lunch, her coworker Colin asks what happened.

Colin: So what happened this morning? You're never late.

Jade: Total nightmare. By the time I got to the station, my train **had already left**.

Colin: Oh no. Did you wait for the next one?

Jade: I was about to, but then I realized **I'd left** my wallet at home.

Colin: Oh, that's the worst! So you went all the way back?

Jade: Yep. And then the next train got stuck in a tunnel for forty minutes.

Colin: What a morning! You should've just stayed in bed.

Jade: No kidding. I just noticed **I'd put on** two different shoes.

Study Notes

Total nightmare.
Đúng là ác mộng.
Dạng rút gọn của "It was a total nightmare", dùng để than về một trải nghiệm tồi tệ.
Cách nói tương đương: It was a disaster.

I was about to, but then…
Mình vừa định thế thì…
"be about to + V" = sắp sửa làm gì. Nói "I was about to" rồi dừng, ngụ ý việc đó không thành.
Cách nói tương đương: I was going to, but…

Speak Like a Native track 9

1. By the time I got to the station, my train had already left.
smooth: "By the time I"
weak: "had"
strong: "already left"
"By the time I" đọc liền một hơi: "bai-đơ-tai-mai". "had" đọc nhẹ /həd/, nối vào "already": "hơ-đol-re-đi". Nhấn "already left": tàu đi mất trước khi mình tới.

2. And then the next train got stuck in a tunnel for forty minutes.
change: "next train" (mất âm t)
linking: "stuck‿in‿a"
strong: "forty minutes"
Âm /t/ của "next" kẹp giữa hai phụ âm nên bị nuốt: "nex-trein". "stuck in a" nối thành "stơ-ki-nơ". Giọng Mỹ đọc "forty" thành "for-đi".

3. I just noticed I'd put on two different shoes.
change: "just noticed" (mất âm t)
linking: "put‿on"
strong: "two different shoes"
"just noticed" đọc /dʒʌs ˈnoʊtɪst/, âm /t/ của "just" mất. "put on" nối thành "pu-đon". "I'd" = I had: xỏ nhầm giày từ trước lúc phát hiện.

- "had" trong quá khứ hoàn thành đọc nhẹ /həd/, hay rút gọn thành 'd: I'd, she'd, they'd.
- "I'd" + V3 (left, gone) = I had; "I'd" + động từ nguyên mẫu = I would.
- Âm /t/ kẹp giữa hai phụ âm thường bị nuốt: next train → "nex-trein".
- Khi kể chuyện xui, nhấn vào chi tiết bất ngờ nhất: TWO DIFFERENT SHOES.

Grammar Focus

Quá khứ hoàn thành: had + V3

Dùng cho việc xảy ra TRƯỚC một việc khác trong quá khứ; việc xảy ra sau dùng quá khứ đơn. Khi nói, "had" thường rút gọn thành 'd.

When we arrived, the movie **had** already **started**.
She **hadn't eaten** all day, so she was starving.
I'd never **seen** snow before that trip.

By the time / realized / found out + quá khứ hoàn thành

Sau "By the time + quá khứ đơn", vế chính dùng had + V3. Sau realized, noticed, found out…, việc xảy ra trước đó dùng had + V3.

By the time he called, **I'd gone** to bed.
She **realized** she **had lost** her keys.
We **found out** the store **had closed**.

Role Play track 13

A: So what happened this morning? You're never late.

B: Total nightmare. By the time I got to the station, my train _____.

A: Oh no. Did you wait for the next one?

B: I was about to, but then I realized _____.

A: Oh, that's the worst! So you went all the way back?

B: Yep. And then the next train got stuck in a tunnel for forty minutes.

A: What a morning! You should've just stayed in bed.

B: No kidding. I just noticed I'd put on _____.

Substitution Drill track 14

1. By the time I got to the station, my train **had already left**.
   a. had just pulled out
   b. had been canceled
   c. had left without me

2. I was about to, but then I realized **I'd left my wallet at home**.
   a. I'd forgotten my phone
   b. I'd lost my train pass
   c. I'd brought the wrong bag

3. I just noticed I'd put on **two different shoes**.
   a. my sweater inside out
   b. two different earrings
   c. my shirt backwards